

Oct 7, 2025

Meeting Oct 7, 2025 at 15:45 CEST

Meeting records  Recording

Summary

Clément Lacaille led a session on automation using Zapier and Make.com, focusing on triggers and actions, with a specific use case of automating LinkedIn content creation. Participants like Vladimir Popovic and Murphy Odion Usunobun learned about LLM selection, connecting apps, and configuring ChatGPT for content generation, including best practices for prompts and managing outputs in Google Sheets. Clément Lacaille guided Vladimir Popovic through the entire process, from setting up Zapier to integrating Google Sheets and ChatGPT for a complete automation workflow, while addressing troubleshooting and emphasizing hands-on practice for all participants.

Details

Notes Length: Standard

- **Automation Tools and Core Concepts** Clément Lacaille introduced two main tools for automation: Zapier and Make.com, emphasizing that the underlying thinking process is more important than the specific tool itself. He outlined the basic components of automation, specifically triggers and actions, with the goal of building a simple automation to create LinkedIn content using Zapier.
- **Setting Up Zapier Account** Clément guided participants through the process of setting up a free Zapier account by signing up with Google. He advised choosing any role when prompted, as it does not affect the UI or features.
- **LLM Selection and Prompting Best Practices** Vladimir Popovic inquired about the choice of Large Language Models (LLMs) and the effectiveness of specific

prompting. Clément explained that while different LLMs might be fine-tuned for specific use cases (e.g., Claude for coding), effective prompting is crucial for any LLM. He also discussed the use of offline LLMs, noting their cost-effectiveness and data privacy benefits, although they might have less frequently updated data compared to online models like ChatGPT 5.

- **Connecting Apps in Zapier** Clément demonstrated how to connect various applications within Zapier, specifically Google Sheets, Google Drive, Gmail, and OpenAI (ChatGPT). He highlighted Zapier's direct integration with Google services as a significant advantage and provided instructions for connecting ChatGPT using an API key and organization ID.
- **Clarifying Connection Issues** Murphy Odion Usunobun, who joined late, asked for clarification on the connection process. Clément reiterated the steps for logging into Zapier and then navigating to "App Connections" to add the necessary applications like Gmail.
- **Understanding Automation Fundamentals** Clément defined automation as a tool for repetitive, rule-based tasks and introduced the two fundamental components: a trigger (an event that starts the automation) and an action (the task performed as a result of the trigger). He provided examples of triggers, such as a Google Form submission or a new lead in a CRM, and actions, such as generating a LinkedIn post.
- **Personalized Automation Examples** Clément encouraged starting with simple, personal automation projects rather than complex business solutions, citing his own first automation for meal prep suggestions as an example. He then presented the day's specific use case: automating LinkedIn post creation by taking a brief input from a Google Sheet, having AI generate the post, and then updating the sheet with the draft.
- **Leveraging ChatGPT for Workflow Planning** Clément demonstrated using ChatGPT (via Chatbot UI) to plan the Zapier automation workflow. He emphasized providing context and asking for step-by-step instructions in simple language, which helped in identifying the necessary triggers and actions within Zapier, such as using Google Sheets for the trigger and ChatGPT for post creation.
- **Building the Zapier Trigger** Clément walked through creating the first part of the Zapier automation, which is setting up the trigger. He chose Google Sheets as the trigger app and explained how to configure the trigger event to "New or

updated spreadsheet row" in a specific sheet, "LinkedIn post," and to monitor a particular column like "creative brief" for updates.

- **Configuring the ChatGPT Action** After setting up the trigger, Clément moved to configuring the action, which involves using ChatGPT to write the LinkedIn post. He selected the "Conversation" event within ChatGPT in Zapier and clarified that this is a basic prompt-response interaction, not a full agent with autonomy.
- **Key Elements of ChatGPT Interaction** Clément highlighted three crucial elements when interacting with an LLM in an agentic platform: the user message (input from the user), the instruction message (system message for OpenAI to follow), and tokens. He emphasized the importance of examples in preventing LLM hallucination and mentioned that a "zero-shot prompt" should produce consistent results every time.
- **AI Content Creation for LinkedIn** Clément Lacaille explained a workflow for creating LinkedIn posts using AI automation on Zapier, emphasizing the importance of following a personal writing style, structure, and template. The goal is to generate system and user messages for a conversation node within Zapier, allowing for iterative content creation with questions asked before answers are provided. The user will determine the post type and provide partial inputs through a creative brief, including the topic, goal (e.g., conversion, views), and target audience.
- **Content Generation Parameters and Feedback** Clément Lacaille specified that Call to Actions (CTAs) should only be included when contextually appropriate, and post length should be between 150 to 300 words. The system instructions should follow a template including role, context, task, example output, and constraints. Vladimir Popovic suggested a minor edit for clarity. Clément Lacaille highlighted that effective communication with AI, rather than tool knowledge, is crucial. They provided feedback to the AI that the exact audience might change (e.g., executives, educators) and asked it to elaborate on this.
- **Zapier Input and Output Configuration** Clément Lacaille demonstrated how to update the system message in Zapier and configure the user message by linking it to specific columns in a Google Sheet for input, such as "creative brief," "what I'm trying to achieve," and "target audience". The process involves replacing unrecognised fields in Zapier by selecting the appropriate columns from the Google Sheet. They provided an example brief about a new animation model,

"van 2.2," aiming to showcase expertise in AI filmmaking and content creation for an audience of content creators and brand managers.

- **Workflow Completion and Post-Generation Evaluation** Clément Lacaille explained how to complete the automation by plugging the AI-generated response back into a Google Sheet, choosing to update a spreadsheet row in the same sheet for simplicity. They noted that Zapier does not immediately display the output data but confirmed the process's success with a green mark. Upon reviewing the generated post about "van 2.2," Clément Lacaille found it good but suggested adding more personalization and examples to the creative brief to trigger a more refined output.
- **Addressing Automation Overwriting and Troubleshooting** Vladimir Popovic questioned why the AI output was not appearing in a new row, to which Clément Lacaille explained it was due to the setting of updating a specific row. To mitigate this, Clément Lacaille suggested creating a new output sheet or a new spreadsheet row instead of updating an existing one, ensuring that new results do not overwrite previous ones and maintain a clear link between input and output.
- **Learning and Practice Recommendations** Clément Lacaille encouraged participants to practice using Zapier and review the session's recording to familiarize themselves with the environment and concepts, emphasizing that hands-on experience is crucial for learning. They offered to stay back to guide anyone through the process, as Naim Burrack expressed difficulty in following the complex steps. Clément Lacaille reiterated that the core idea is to define the AI's role, context, task, and input/output structure clearly.
- **Future Project Preview** Clément Lacaille provided a glimpse into the next three-day project, which involves building a workflow to generate video content from a product image and text input, aiming to create social media content. They stressed that while the current session focused on basic automation, the future project will iterate on these concepts to ensure better understanding.
- **Guided Practice Session** Vladimir Popovic volunteered to share their screen for a guided practice session, starting a new Zap in Zapier and configuring Google Sheets as the trigger event. Clément Lacaille guided Vladimir Popovic through setting up the spreadsheet trigger, choosing a new or updated spreadsheet row as the event, and selecting the appropriate worksheet and trigger column. Vladimir Popovic then created a Google Sheet with relevant columns for input,

such as "creative brief," "what I'm trying to achieve," and "target audience," to provide data for the AI.

- **Developing AI System and User Messages** Clément Lacaille guided Vladimir Popovic in crafting system and user messages in ChatGPT. The system message defined the AI's role as an expert in writing SEO-based content for digital marketers, with the task of generating system and user messages for a Zapier automation workflow using the conversation node. The output style was specified to be data-driven and follow a specific style, with a constraint of keeping the output under 150 words. The user message would include the Excel column data as input for ChatGPT.
- **Setting up Zapier with Chat GPT** Clément Lacaille guided Vladimir Popovic through the process of setting up an automation workflow in Zapier using Chat GPT. Vladimir Popovic was instructed to copy specific user and system messages from Chat GPT into Zapier to define the workflow. They emphasized the need for the user message to include columns in a JSON structure for mapping Excel sheet fields.
- **Connecting Google Sheets and Chat GPT in Zapier** Clément Lacaille and Vladimir Popovic worked on linking Google Sheets to Chat GPT within Zapier, addressing issues where Zapier couldn't recognize data without pre-filled columns. They demonstrated how to test the trigger in Google Sheets and map the columns for input into Chat GPT, ensuring the data flows correctly between the applications. The system message was highlighted as the "heart of any automation" for refining the output.
- **Outputting Results to Google Sheets** The final step involved configuring Zapier to output the generated Chat GPT responses back into a Google Sheet. Vladimir Popovic mapped the Chat GPT output to a "finished post" column in the Google Sheet, successfully completing the automation. Clément Lacaille congratulated Vladimir Popovic on successfully setting up the workflow and encouraged other participants to practice the steps demonstrated.

Suggested next steps

- ☐ Clément Lacaille will ensure the documentation of the exact prompt used in ChatGPT for writing system and user messages is available in the classroom document and the Slack group.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will plug the generated response back to the post sheet to complete the automation.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will add more context to the creative brief by including personal examples of using van 2.2 for a jewelry brand story and updating the target audience to 'content creators working at e-commerce firms' or 'D2C e-commerce house'.
- ☐ Vladimir Popovic will delete everything and start from the beginning by creating a new Zap.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will upload the recording in the morning.

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